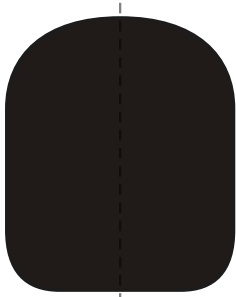


Elytra body ×1

black · the broad wing-cases · actual size



dashed = centre line (guide, don't cut)

Orange bands ×2

orange · two wavy bands · actual size



band 1 · the broad front band

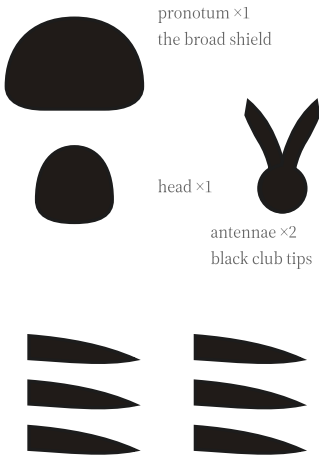


band 2 · the rear band (a touch smaller)

These lie across the black back — black shows between them and at the tail.

Head & legs

black · actual size



legs ×6 · black · stout, three each side

Finished!

the same pieces, assembled



black body · 2 orange bands · ≈ 5 × 4 cm

The real thing



Nicrophorus vespilloides — the common burying beetle, carrying mites.

Photo © nevwright, CC BY, via iNaturalist. Photographed in Greater Manchester — about 11 km from the city centre.

Did you know?

- It's an undertaker! It buries dead mice and small birds.
- A rare insect that cares for its young — parents feed them.
- Nicknamed the 'sexton' or 'undertaker' beetle.
- It can smell a dead animal from far away.
- The orange blobs are tiny mites hitching a ride.

How to make it

from your felt squares

- 1 Trace each shape onto the right felt colour.
- 2 Cut out all 13 pieces.
- 3 Build it on the mat →

Felt squares you'll use:

- black — body, head, legs, antennae
- orange — the 2 back bands

Brown soil mat/pouch is premade.

Build it

lay the pieces on the mat

- 1 Lay the brown mat down — that's the soil.
- 2 Place the black elytra body, then the pronotum & head.
- 3 Lay the two orange bands across the back.

Nothing is fixed — the pieces just sit like a jigsaw.

...and again

it's a puzzle, not a glue-up

- 4 Add the two clubbed antennae at the front.
- 5 Tuck the 6 legs under — three each side.
- 6 Done! Take it apart and build it all again.

Move the bands a little each time — no two are quite alike.

At a glance

13 felt pieces

- 1 elytra body (black)
- 2 orange bands
- 1 pronotum (black)
- 1 head (black)
- 2 antennae (black)
- 6 legs (black)

Finished size

≈ 5 × 4 cm

Theme: Underground. Collect the longhorn and scarab beetle too.



Make your own

Burying Beetle Instructions

A Giant Insect World felt puzzle  
build it · take it apart · build it again



FuzzleWorld

downloadable felt puzzle kits

Collect the set

Meadow · Aquatic · Underground

burying beetle · longhorn · scarab  
ladybird · dragonfly · more...

Species: N. vespilloides · Photo ©  
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Giant Insect World